



NCLEX SKIN CONDITIONS OVERVIEW

1. WHAT IS A SKIN CONDITION?

- A **skin condition** is any disorder that affects the **skin, hair, or nails**.
- Some are **temporary (like rashes)**, while others are **chronic (long-term)**.
- Causes include:
 - ♦ Infections (bacterial, viral, fungal, or parasitic).
 - ♦ Inflammation (allergic reactions, autoimmune diseases).
 - ♦ Environmental factors (sun exposure, irritants, humidity).

2. COMMON SKIN CONDITIONS & THEIR CAUSES

Condition	Cause (What Triggers It?)	Symptoms (What It Looks Like?)
Acne	Hormones, clogged pores, bacteria (Propionibacterium acnes)	Pimples, blackheads, whiteheads, cysts (deep painful lumps)
Eczema (Atopic Dermatitis)	Genetics, allergies, asthma	Itchy, dry, red, scaly patches (often on hands, elbows, knees)
Psoriasis	Autoimmune disease (body attacks its own skin cells)	Thick, scaly, silver patches on skin (often on scalp, elbows, knees)
Hives (Urticaria)	Allergic reaction, stress, infection	Raised, red, itchy welts (come and go quickly)
Shingles (Herpes Zoster)	Reactivation of Varicella-Zoster Virus (chickenpox virus)	Painful, blistering rash along nerve paths (often on one side of body)
Impetigo		

Condition	Cause (What Triggers It?)	Symptoms (What It Looks Like?)
	Bacterial infection (Staphylococcus or Streptococcus bacteria)	Honey-colored crusted sores (usually on face, common in children)
Ringworm (Tinea Corporis)	Fungal infection (spread by skin contact or animals)	Red, circular, scaly rash with a clear center ("ring-shaped")
Scabies	Mites burrowing under skin (Sarcoptes scabiei)	Intense itching, small red bumps, worse at night
Melasma	Hormonal changes (pregnancy, birth control, sun exposure)	Dark patches on face (forehead, cheeks, upper lip)
Vitiligo	Loss of melanin (skin pigment)	White patches of skin (can spread over time)

3. TREATMENT OF COMMON SKIN CONDITIONS

A. BACTERIAL SKIN INFECTIONS (IMPETIGO, CELLULITIS, FOLLICULITIS)

- ✓ Antibiotic Ointments (Mupirocin, Bacitracin) for minor cases.
- ✓ Oral Antibiotics (Cephalexin, Clindamycin) for severe cases.
- ✓ Keep affected areas clean & avoid touching lesions.

B. VIRAL SKIN CONDITIONS (SHINGLES, WARTS, HERPES SIMPLEX)

- ✓ Antiviral Medications (Acyclovir, Valacyclovir) for Shingles & Herpes.
- ✓ Pain Management (NSAIDs, Lidocaine Cream) for Shingles.
- ✓ Shingles Vaccine (Zoster Vaccine) for prevention (for adults >50).

C. FUNGAL SKIN CONDITIONS (RINGWORM, ATHLETE'S FOOT, CANDIDIASIS)

- ✓ Antifungal Creams (Clotrimazole, Miconazole) for mild cases.
- ✓ Oral Antifungal Medications (Fluconazole, Terbinafine) for widespread infections.
- ✓ Keep skin dry & wear loose clothing (fungus thrives in moisture).

D. PARASITIC SKIN CONDITIONS (SCABIES, LICE)

- ✓ Permethrin Cream (kills scabies mites).
- ✓ Wash clothes & bedding in hot water.
- ✓ Treat all household members to prevent reinfection.

E. CHRONIC SKIN CONDITIONS (ECZEMA, PSORIASIS, VITILIGO, MELASMA)

- ✓ Moisturizers (to prevent dryness & itching).
- ✓ Topical Steroids (Hydrocortisone, Triamcinolone) to reduce inflammation.
- ✓ Phototherapy (Light Therapy) for Vitiligo & Psoriasis.
- ✓ Sunscreen (prevents worsening of Melasma & Vitiligo).

4. NCLEX PRIORITIES FOR SKIN CONDITIONS

- ✓ Teach Patients to Avoid Scratching (Prevents Infection).
- ✓ Use Hypoallergenic Soaps & Moisturizers for Sensitive Skin.
- ✓ For Fungal Infections – Keep Skin Dry & Avoid Sharing Personal Items.
- ✓ For Bacterial Infections – Wash Hands & Cover Sores to Prevent Spread.
- ✓ For Shingles – Avoid Contact with Pregnant Women & Immunocompromised People.

5. SKIN CANCER (MALIGNANT SKIN CONDITIONS)

Skin Cancer Type	Cause	Appearance	Risk Factors
Basal Cell Carcinoma (BCC)	Sun exposure, UV radiation	Waxy bump, pearly border, slow-growing	Fair skin, sunburns, long-term sun exposure
Squamous Cell Carcinoma (SCC)	Sun exposure, chronic wounds	Scaly, red patch or ulcer, can spread	Fair skin, sun exposure, HPV infection
Melanoma	Genetic + UV radiation	Irregular dark mole, changing in size, color, shape	Fair skin, tanning beds, many moles, family history

ABCDE RULE FOR SKIN CANCER DETECTION

- ♦ **A – Asymmetry** (One side looks different than the other).
- ♦ **B – Border Irregularity** (Edges are uneven, not smooth).
- ♦ **C – Color Changes** (Multiple colors in one mole).
- ♦ **D – Diameter >6mm** (Larger than a pencil eraser).
- ♦ **E – Evolving** (Growing, itching, bleeding, or changing in appearance).

✓ Treatment for Skin Cancer:

- Surgical Removal (Excision, Mohs Surgery).
- Chemotherapy or Radiation for Advanced Cases.
- Sunscreen & Avoiding Tanning Beds to Prevent Skin Cancer.

6. NCLEX "MUST-KNOW" SKIN CONDITION CONCEPTS

- ♦ Shingles = Painful, blistering rash → Give Acyclovir + Pain Meds!
- ♦ Ringworm = Circular red rash → Treat with Antifungal Creams!
- ♦ Scabies = Itchy rash, worse at night → Treat with Permethrin Cream!
- ♦ Melanoma = Irregular dark mole → Urgent Dermatology Referral!

- ♦ **Psoriasis = Silvery, scaly patches → Treat with Steroids + UV Therapy!**
- ♦ **Eczema = Itchy, dry skin → Moisturize + Avoid Triggers!**